

CAMSAIL PROGRAMME

2023 – 2024

Winter Programme for Sailors Living In or Near Cambridge

CAMSAIL is a club which meets monthly from October to March to enjoy a wide range of illustrated talks, given by invited speakers and club members, and provides an opportunity to socialise in a nautical atmosphere (albeit in central Cambridge!).

Our monthly meetings are on Wednesday evenings at 19.30 for 19.45. We meet in the Cambridge and County Bowling Club, Brooklands Avenue, CB2 8FG. The club is situated towards the west end of Brooklands Avenue on the north side, and parking is available there. There is a bar open before each meeting; tea and coffee are served after each meeting.

There is an annual subscription (to cover the cost of the venue and speakers' expenses), but those new to us are welcome to attend one meeting without charge or any commitment to join.

October 11th: Tales of a Harbour Master

Robert Smith: In 2000, Robert became Wells Harbour Master. In 2016/7 he was recognised in the New Year's Honours List and awarded an MBE for his services to the Port and Community of Wells. Tales of a Harbour Master not only take his audience on a journey of discovery of the history and workings of the Port, but also provide a light-hearted & amusing glimpse of his life as Harbour Master. He is often asked what he enjoys most about his work; his reply is always the same: 'Fresh Air & Freedom'.

November 8th: Racing the Fastnet in a First 40

Carl Lamb: The Fastnet is a race of many challenges, including negotiating infamous headlands and tidal gates such as St Albans Head, Portland Bill, The Lizard and Land's End, and facing prevailing south-westerlies and gales in the Celtic Sea. Carl has undertaken three Fastnet campaigns in First 40s, and will tell of what it is like competing in a normal sized yacht, which on most days is in cruising mode, and how the crew prepare for the challenge ahead of them.

December 13th: Members' Evening

Camsail AGM; election of Committee for 2024; a chance to share sailing experiences and to get to know other members better (with Christmas refreshments), including reports from the Camsail trips of last season.

Our club, now in its fourteenth season, has a membership of around 50. Some of the members have or have had their own yachts, others enjoy sailing by chartering or as crew, others have sailed in the past or are simply interested in things nautical!

Our club welcomes a connection with the Cruising Association (www.theca.org.uk) through their Suffolk Section. The Camsail programme will be published in the C.A. quarterly magazine.

Committee (2023):

Chairman: Peter Jones

Secretary: John Aylmer

Treasurer: Malcolm Dee

Member: Jim Hibbert

Member: Ann Jackson

Member: John Peregrine

If you would like further details, please visit our website:

www.camsail.org.uk

or contact us at: enquiries@camsail.org.uk

January 10th: Doctor At Sea

Stuart Withington: finally realised his ambition to sail across the Atlantic when he signed up to do the ARC in 2013. Being the only medically qualified member of the crew, he was made the ship's doctor and charged with preparing the medical kit. He will talk about how he decided on what instruments and medicines to take, and what preparations were made for that (and subsequent) voyages. The talk will cover various aspects of yacht design that may have medical consequences.

February 14th: to be arranged

March 13th: (i) Grafham Water Sailability

Graham Cox: RYA Sailability enables disabled people to sail. A range of disabilities, physical and mental, provide interesting challenges. GWS has a fleet of 12 Challenger trimarans, variously adapted, and other boats for particular requirements.

(ii) Dawn Rose - Living Abroad

Mike Pearce: Departing from Ipswich Haven in May 2012, we have cruised Dawn Rose, our Hanse 370, down the Atlantic coast and across the Mediterranean over the past 11 years. She is currently based in the Argolic Gulf. Hear our experiences of the locations where we have stored Dawn Rose en route, including some of the pros and cons of being based in foreign waters.